

area for cleaning.

- *Countertops:* Check the countertop for chips, cracks, and stains. Note what material it's made of, if that's important to you.

Bathrooms

- *Plumbing and drainage:* Fill up the sink and let the water run out to test for backups or poorly performing drains. If possible, check the ceiling of the room underneath the bathroom for any sign of leaks.
- *Toilet:* Does it rock or is it solidly on the floor? Flush the toilet.
- *Tub:* Any cracks or chips? What condition is the caulk in? Is there mold around the tub?
- *Vanity:* Check the condition. You can check for leaks from all faucets by looking inside the bathroom vanity.
- *Ventilation:* Does the fan work? Is there a window? Does it open and close easily? If possible, make sure the fan vents to the outside, not the attic.

Basement

- *Odor:* What does it smell like? An overpowering odor can be a sign of mold or mildew.
- *Efflorescence:* Do you see white marks on the cement walls? This could indicate past water intrusion or damage.
- *Walls:* Do the walls have any cracks? Small, hairline cracks are not so concerning, but large cracks—especially horizontal ones—can indicate bigger foundation problems.
- *Floor slope:* Does the basement slope in any direction?
- *Furnace:* Are there any stickers that indicate the installation date? Look at the filter. An extremely dirty filter may signal poor maintenance—both for the furnace as well as the rest of the home.
- *Water heater:* Check for water around the base of the water heater. Are there any stickers on this to indicate the manufacture or installation date?

Exterior

- *Fence:* Walk the fence to check for loose boards and overall sturdiness.